

AN EVIDENCE BRIEF FOR FOUNDERS

The \$282 Startup

A thousand companies with verified revenue. Here is what normal actually looks like, and the six calls the data says you should be making differently.



1,000

companies



\$133.8M

revenue, last 12 months



65

countries



26%

already for sale

Every figure here was recomputed from the source file. Read the caveats near the end before you act on any of it.

START HERE

Half of these companies make less than \$282 a month.

Everyone benchmarks against screenshots. This is the actual ladder. Climbing from the middle to the top quarter means growing 17x, and most companies never

\$282

Median MRR

the middle of all 1,000 companies

\$10,607

The 80th percentile

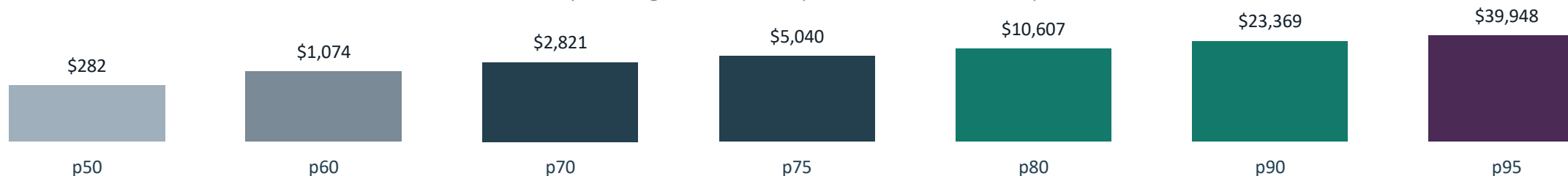
clear \$10k and you are top fifth

21.2%

Ever get there

212 companies, at any age

Monthly recurring revenue at each percentile of the 1,000 companies



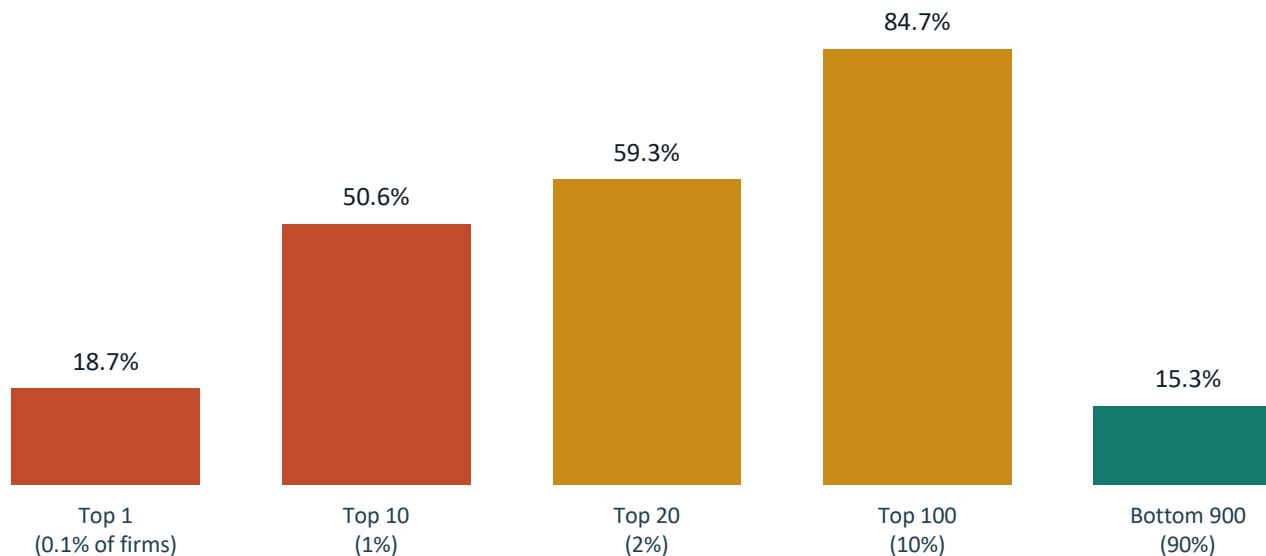
DO THIS

Find your rung before you set next quarter's number. Going from the median to the top quarter is a 17x climb. Treat that as the whole year, not a checkpoint on the way to a million.

Ten companies own half the money in this file.

One company, Stan, books 18.7% of all trailing revenue by itself. Mean MRR is \$13,472. The median is \$282. Anyone quoting an average off data like this is quoting ten outliers.

Slice of the \$133.8M earned in the last twelve months



WHY IT MATTERS

- The mean is 48 times the median. It describes no company in this file.
- Any pitch deck citing "average revenue per startup" off numbers like these is selling you something.
- Your realistic band is the middle to the top tenth. In money, that is \$282 to \$23,369 a month.



DO THIS

Delete every average from your model and your fundraising deck. Put a median and a top-quarter figure in their place, and say out loud which one you are betting the year on.

WHAT THE DATA ARGUES FOR

Six decisions

1

Who you sell to

Price is the whole B2B premium

3

Where the hours go

Reach beats pricing by ten to one

5

Where leverage lives

Authority pays. Audience mostly does not

2

Your route to \$10k

90 customers, or 2,348

4

Which category

Crowded and lucrative are different things

6

How you read yourself

Levels are signal. Monthly deltas are noise

The B2B premium is a pricing premium. That is all.

B2B companies here clear 5.7 times the median MRR of B2C. It is not because they have more customers. The median B2B company actually has fewer.

Median monthly recurring revenue



Median revenue per subscriber per month, which is where the gap comes from



	B2B	B2C
Median subscribers	16	19
Median per customer	\$49.00	\$9.30
Median MRR	\$1,036	\$181
Odds of clearing \$10k	25.1%	16.0%
Share listed for sale	25.1%	31.4%

The median B2B company has fewer customers than the median B2C one, 16 against 19. It simply charges five times as much for each.



DO THIS

Settle your price point before you write more code. If you are landing under \$25 a head, you need 400 paying customers to reach \$10k. Budget the support load now, not when it arrives.

Two roads to \$10k a month. Pick one and commit.

Among the 212 companies above \$10k, two models show up in almost equal numbers. Same revenue line, twenty-six times the difference in how many people you have to find, sell and support.

ROUTE A • PRICE

90

customers, at \$100 or more each

62 companies got here this way. Fewer relationships, higher expectations. This is a sales job, and it works when somebody on the other side has a budget line.

Typical of B2B tooling, marketing and analytics

ROUTE B • VOLUME

2,348

customers, at under \$25 each

68 companies took this road, almost the same count. This is a distribution job. No sales team will rescue it, and every new dollar drags more support behind it.

Typical of mobile apps, productivity and consumer AI



DO THIS

Write down which road you are on and what it costs. Route A needs a named buyer and a sales motion. Route B needs a channel that compounds. Companies that hedge end up with neither.

Companies above \$10k won on reach, not on price.

Set the 212 companies above \$10k against the 591 that earn something but stay below it. The customer gap is ten times wider than the pricing gap.

How many times bigger the \$10k+ group is on each measure



READ IT LIKE THIS

- 32.6 times the customers. 3.0 times the price. That is the whole story.
- Raising prices is a real lever. It is just a far smaller one than it feels like from the inside.
- Distribution is what is actually binding here, not monetisation.
- Followers are the weakest thing on the board at 2.4 times.



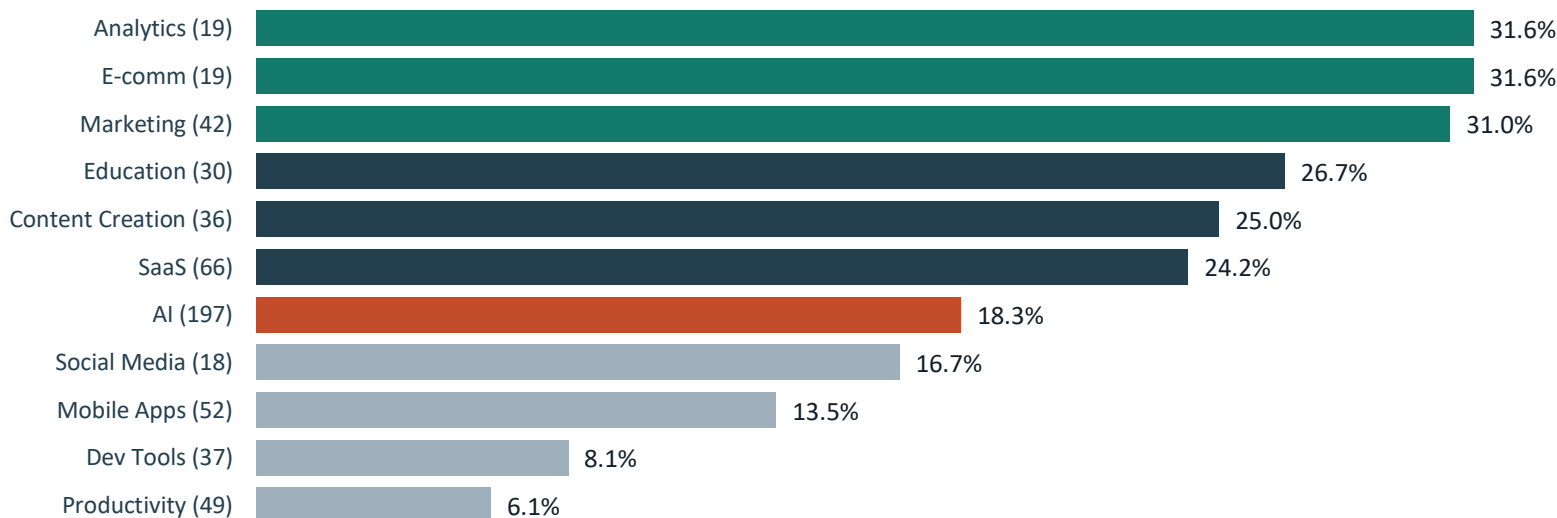
DO THIS

Go back through where last month's hours went. If more than half landed on the product and the pricing page, you spent them on the 3x lever and left the 33x one alone.

The most crowded category has worse than average odds.

AI holds 197 companies, three times the next biggest. Only 18.3% of them clear \$10k a month, against a 21.2% base rate. Analytics and Marketing are a third the size and sit at the top of the table.

Share of each category clearing \$10k a month, company count in brackets. Base rate is 21.2%



197

companies in AI

the most crowded slot by far

18.3%

of them clear \$10k

below the 21.2% base rate



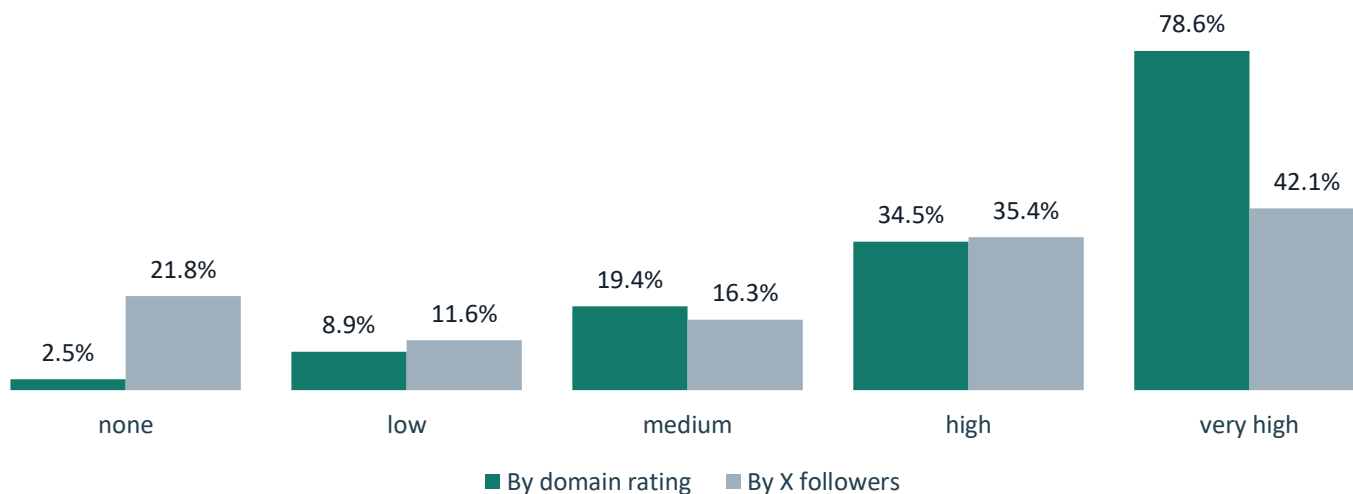
DO THIS

If you have not launched, price the category choice honestly. Entering AI means 197 competitors for below average odds. If you are already in it, your edge has to be the channel, because the model is not the moat.

Followers barely move revenue. Search authority moves it.

Rank correlation with revenue: followers 0.21, domain rating 0.57. The 307 companies with no followers out-earn the 225 that have a handful.

Share clearing \$10k a month. Domain rating bands 0 / 1-10 / 10-30 / 30-50 / 50+. Follower bands 0 / 1-100 / 100-1k / 1k-10k / 10k+



THE GAP

78.6%

of companies with a domain rating above 50 clear \$10k, against 2.5% at zero. A thirty-one fold spread.

42.1%

is the best that ten thousand followers buys you, barely double the 21.8% earned by companies with none.



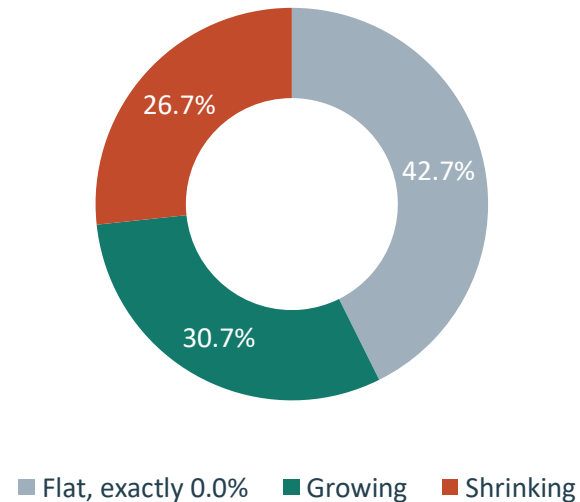
DO THIS

Move an hour a day out of posting and into publishing. Ship pages that get indexed, earn links, and set a domain rating target instead of a follower target. Ten to thirty roughly doubles your odds. Thirty to fifty doubles them again.

Almost nobody here has momentum, including the good ones.

Only 30.7% grew at all last month. Another 42.7% report growth of exactly 0.0%, which is a broken feed rather than a result. Flat is simply the normal month.

Change in monthly revenue over the last 30 days



WHAT FOLLOWS

- A flat month is not a failing month. It is the single most common outcome among companies that already proved somebody will pay them.
- Growth here is wild. One company reports plus 12,983% because it grew off almost nothing. Never take one month of somebody else's percentage seriously.
- The 42.7% sitting at exactly zero almost certainly reflects stale syncs and no subscription events, so treat any single month figure as noise, including your own.
- The number that holds up is your level, not your change.



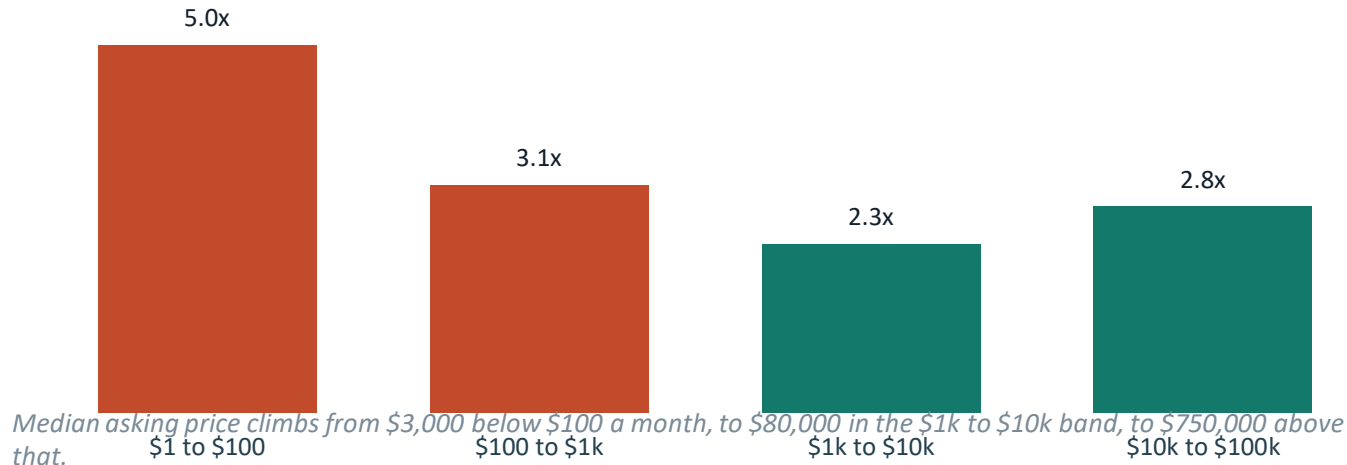
DO THIS

Drop month on month growth as your headline metric. Compare the last ninety days of revenue against the ninety before it. At this size, monthly percentages are mostly noise.

A quarter of this file is for sale, at 2.3 times revenue.

There are 262 listings. Asking price tracks revenue at 0.90 rank correlation, so the multiple is the only thing left to argue about. The smallest sellers ask for the most.

Asking multiple by seller size, grouped by monthly revenue



\$35,000

Median asking price

across all 262 listings

16

listings with no revenue

and they still want \$4,000



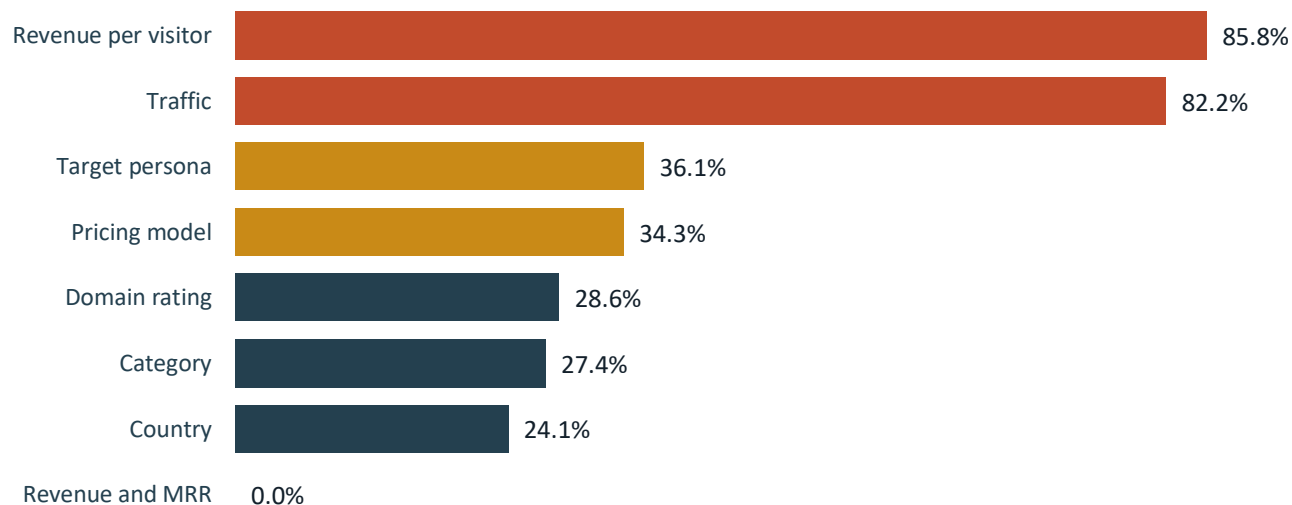
DO THIS

If you might ever sell, get past \$1k a month first. Below that the market runs on hope, and sixteen listings with zero revenue are still asking four thousand dollars. Above it, buyers price your cash flow and your number holds up.

Revenue is verified. Nearly everything else is self reported.

This file is unusually solid on money and unusually thin on context. Knowing which is which is the difference between a useful read and a confident mistake.

Share of the 1,000 rows with no value recorded



THREE WARNINGS

- Forget funnel analysis. 82% of rows have no traffic data, so any conversion figure would rest on 178 companies rather than a thousand.
- Category and country splits point in a direction and nothing more. A quarter of rows carry no label, and those gaps are unlikely to be random.
- Survivorship runs through all of it. These companies got themselves listed on a revenue verification site. The ones that never charged anybody are not in the file.



DO THIS

Use this to calibrate and to rule things out, not to size a market or forecast your own curve. Wherever a slide leans on fewer than thirty companies, treat it as a hypothesis worth testing.

THE WHOLE THING IN SIX LINES

What to do on Monday

1

Find your rung

The median is \$282 a month and the 80th percentile is \$10,607. Set next quarter against that, not against Twitter.

3

Buy reach, not polish

Winners hold 32.6 times the customers and only 3 times the price. Distribution is the constraint. Move your hours there.

5

Build authority

A domain rating above 50 gets you to 78.6%. Ten thousand followers gets you 42.1%. Publish things that get indexed.

2

Price on purpose

Choose your per-customer number before you build. Under \$25 means 400 customers to hit \$10k. Over \$100 means ninety, plus a sales motion.

4

Take odds over hype

AI is 197 companies at below average odds. If you stay, win on channel, because the model is not the moat.

6

Watch levels, not deltas

42.7% of monthly growth figures read exactly zero. Report rolling ninety day revenue instead.

A thousand companies, six decisions. The median one makes \$282 a month, and that is the room you are actually competing in.